Welcome to the LVNA

Villager

The Newsletter of the Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village Neighborhood Association

Lakewood Village, Sunnyvale, California

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To subscribe to the Lakewood Village mailing list, send a blank email to: lakewoodvillage-subscribe@topica.com

Visit www.lvna.net

Next LVNA Meeting:

Wednesday, October 9th, 7:00 pm, Fairwood School

Magkakaroon po nang pagpupulong ang LVNA
sa 9 Oktubre, 2002, 7:00 pm sa Fairwood School

Proxima junta de LVNA sera efectuada
el 9 Octubre, 2002 a las 7:00 pm en el Fairwood School

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News and Features

President's Column

- Craig Crawford
President, LVNA

The annual Lakewood Village picnic was a total success. We had over 200 neighbors sign in for a free lunch and fellowship. The picnic had a rocky start when I went to put the reservation cards up at the picnic site. The site was being claimed by another group (already drinking at 6:30am!) who were staking out the tables. A quick talk to the people from Parks and Recreation cleared that up.

Most of the volunteers arrived by 10:00am, and we were in full gear by 11:00am. It was starting to look gloomy at 11:30am with the volunteers outnumbering the neighbors. That would change soon, and by 12:00 noon the picnic was hoppin', hotdogs were plumping up,

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hamburgers were sizzling, and the grill was releasing a smell that could only mean one thing: a big neighborhood party.

It was good to see friends that I haven't seen for awhile. Several of our neighbors brought plates of colorful salads, festive cookies and tasty snacks. We had a diverse picnic with most of Lakewood's several nationalities present as well as the different ethnic food that they brought to the table. It was really fun to sample food from exotic pacific islands to the spicy food of Mexico.

We were visited by several of our highly respected council members, Tim Risch, John Howe, Julia Miller and of course our much-loved Mayor Fred Fowler, thanks for the support.

The raffle drawing had people's interest, but we did not have a loudspeaker to use for calling out the raffle ticket numbers, and so I

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stood on a table and used my best ex-military "from the diaphragm" voice to call the winning numbers. This was real excitement, all the raffle prizes were wonderful, and the grand prize was anticipated with baited breath. At the end of the day, we all had had a good time. If you missed this year's picnic, you missed a lot of fun.



Here is a list of the people and merchants who helped make this year's picnic such a success. If I missed anyone who donated or helped, let me know and you'll be in next month's edition.

- Tom Watkins from TW painting for supplying the hot dogs.
- Central Cash and Carry for the chili.
- Kathy's Baskets for raffle prizes. They were fabulous!
- Sunnyvale's Parks and Recreation department for the flowers that were potted.
- Sunnyvale Public Safety for the fire truck and tours within.
- Pizza Depot for raffle prizes.
- Virginia Lindstrom and family of Re/Max Realty for the balloons.
- Lakewood Valero for raffle prizes
- Lakewood Barber shop for raffle prizes; thanks Stephen!
- Phyllis Fowler for face painting.
- Coco's Restaurant for the wonderful pies.
- Lakewood Construction for the sodas.
- Lake Vista Liquors store for the ice.
- EL Mero Mero Restaurant for the nachos.
- Instyle Beauty Salon for a very generous donation and raffle prizes.
- Jim and Helen Lane for the patriotic sheet cake.
- All the volunteers that helped cook, serve, cleanup.
- All of you for attending and having fun! ■

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Dick's Lakewood Center
1157 N. Lawrence Expwy.
Sunnyvale, CA 94089

Parade Planning Season

- Craig Crawford
President, LVNA

This is the season for Santa's helpers to start planning for the annual Lakewood Village Holiday Parade. If you have a group, social club, sporting team, Church group, Sunday school, car club, singing club, dancing club, or any other kind of groups or clubs that would like to participate in the parade, let an LVNA Board member know and we will follow up and get them into the parade. We also need volunteers to help set up and run the parade and to serve refreshments at the end of the parade.

The Parade is put on by our neighborhood for the enjoyment of our neighborhood. It's not merely the best holiday parade in the City of Sunnyvale, it's the ***only*** holiday parade in the City of Sunnyvale! We need your help to produce this event and to bring joy to our children (and to the child that resides in all of us adults). Don't say "I'll call tomorrow", call today and make a stand to help your neighborhood organization and the residents of the greatest community in all of Sunnyvale. ■

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From the Editor's Desk

- Editor

Changes in the newsletter

This month, I'm trying something new: articles are grouped according to whether they are News, Editorials, or Announcements. Also, there's a little "table of contents" on the front page. Let me know what you think of it.

What's New on www.lvna.net

If you haven't looked at our web site yet, please do! Recent updates include a new section that will contain information and photo galleries for Lakewood Village neighborhood events and activities. The address of the web site is **http://www.lvna.net**.

Keep those cards and letters coming!

"Letters to the LVNA" has been a popular, if not somewhat provocative feature. Keep those letters coming, but please try to make them brief and to the point.

Do you want to be a Villager Reporter?

I'm looking for people to file reports and take photographs of neighborhood-related events and activities. Contact me if you're interested!

To contact the Editor of The Villager...

Send your letters to the editor, articles, comments, and corrections by email to editor@lvna.net (new email address!), by FAX to (408) 738-2821, or by postal mail to LVNA Villager, c/o Brian Smithson, 1104 Burntwood Court, Sunnyvale CA 94089. ■

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Internet Hoaxes and Chain Letters

- Brian Smithson

Is there really an email attachment that will erase my hard disk, and also destroy my sound card, speakers, and keyboard?

Did someone send me a recipe for cookies from Neiman-Marcus that originally cost $200?

Can I really help the cause of the women of Afghanistan by forwarding an email to everyone I know? Will forwarding a different email help pay for medical treatment for a desperately ill person?

How rich can I get if I help an exiled African guy get his millions of dollars back, using my bank account to do the wire transfers?

Did Pepsi (or was that Dr. Pepper?) remove the phrase "under God" from the Pledge of Allegiance on their patriotic soda can label?

And did that English kid who was dying of cancer fulfill his last wish by getting enough business cards to get into the Guinness Book of World Records?

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These questions and many more like them are answered in email messages on the Internet – and they're all hoaxes. Email hoaxes often prey upon people's fears or hopes, on their concern for others, or sometimes on their greed. At best, they spread fear and misinformation; at worst, they're scams. Here's how to detect email hoaxes and stop them in their tracks:

First, give it a sanity test. Email hoaxes usually have several characteristics in common. If you get an email with one or more of these, you should suspect that it is a hoax:

- It says that it is really important, a "must read", urgent message that you should read right now.
- It doesn't relate first-hand experience, but instead says that a friend of a friend or someone's cousin had it happen to them or otherwise knows that it's true.
- It cites some sort of large authority, like saying that it was on CNN, or Microsoft announced it on their web site, or the US Government has reported it.
- It urges you to forward a copy of the message to everyone you know.
- If you think about it for a few minutes, it really seems unbelievable, but it still captures your interest "just in case it's true".

Second, go to one of these authorities on hoaxes and urban legends:

http://www.UrbanLegends.com
http://www.TruthOrFiction.com
http://www.BreakTheChain.org

Look at the most recent listings or search for a few key words that you find in the email, and you'll probably find out that the email you received is indeed a hoax.

If it's a hoax, <u>don't forward it</u>!

What you do after that is up to you. What I usually do is that I send a polite reply to the person who forwarded it to me and I explain things in much the same way I've explained them in this article.

This is really important. Clip out this article and send it to everyone you know. ☺ ■

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This Month in Lakewood History...

- Brian Smithson

44 years ago: In 1958, groundbreaking was held for the Lakewood Methodist Church (still operating in the same location!).



This is the rear of the church as it appeared in 1959, a view from Oak Creek Way that is now obscured by houses.

43 years ago: In 1959, Dick's Supermarket and the shopping plaza opened for business.

38 years ago: In 1964, Lakewood Park was dedicated.

11 years ago: In 1991, the LVNA was formed. Happy Birthday, LVNA!

Share <u>your</u> history!

Are you a long-time resident of Lakewood Village? Do you have old photographs, real estate brochures, newspaper clippings, or old LVRA/LVNA newsletters sitting in a box in your garage? I'd be happy to pick up items, copy them, and return the originals. Call me at 738-5939 or email editor@lvna.net. ■

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What's going on at Lakewood School?

Dear Neighbors and Friends,
We would like to invite you to join us in supporting our school. The Lakewood Parent Teacher Organization strives to enrich our children's academic experience. In order to do this, fundraisers are done to supplement teacher's expenses incurred throughout the year. This includes field trips, special projects, etc. PTO sponsors "Meet the Masters" which is a program that exposes our children to some of the greatest artists in history. PTO also funds all the assemblies, Italian Dinner Night, Teacher Appreciation Lunch, Card Making Night and the end of the year party called Fun Day. We would greatly appreciate any support.

Thank you,
Lakewood PTO

eScrip It's free!

eScrip is a fundraising program that allows participating merchants to contribute a percentage of your grocery cards, credit cards, and debit/ATM card purchases to the school or organization of your choice. eScrip is the best vehicle for simple, year-round fundraising. Continue to use the cards that you always use, and earn money for your neighborhood school at the same time.
Please sign up! You can register online at
www.escrip.com
Lakewood's ID# is 0139572349

Book Fair November 4-8

Christmas is coming!
Why not give the gift of reading.
Last Spring we raised over $3000 worth of books. They will be used as prizes for the Accelerated Reading Program that will be getting started again real soon. We were also able to donate books to each teachers' classroom library and the school library.
The book fair will be open Monday-Friday from 11:30-3:00 pm. and also on Thursday evening from 6:00-8:00 pm.

Westfield Works Wonders

Sunday Nov. 10th from 7:00 to 10:00 pm
Tickets are $5.00 per person. Children under 12 free.
100% of the ticket sales go to Lakewood PTO.
This is a special night of benefit shopping held after regular mall hours at Valley Fair and Oakridge Malls. Shoppers enjoy a fantastic night of shopping, complete with exclusive, deep discounts, free gift wrapping, entertainment, food discounts, prizes and a coupon for a future free photo with Santa. The mall comes alive with the sights and sounds of the season.
Tickets are on sale in the front office at Lakewood School.

Lakewood Dine-Out Night

This year we are trying something new! Each month we will have one night where a restaurant will donate a percentage of it's proceeds from Lakewood School customers.
Depending on the restaurant you will either need to provide a coupon or say you are with Lakewood School.
October 8th 11:00 am—9:00 pm
Will be held at Chevys on Mathilda near the Town Center.
Please don't hesitate to pass coupons out to friends and co-workers for lunch or dinner.
A coupon is required. Copies are accepted.
Only one coupon needed per check.

cut this out **Coupon** cut this out

Chevys FRESH MEX

Mathilda location only

Chevys will donate 20% of the proceeds to Lakewood PTO.
Oct. 8th 11:00 am—9:00 pm

5th grade selling cookie dough and cheesecakes for Science camp Nov. 4-18

Please come by the school or ask your neighbor if they have a 5th grader trying to earn money for Science Camp.



Opinions and Editorials

Dog: Man's Best Friend, or... What Did I Step In?

- Craig Crawford

When was the last time that you were sleeping soundly, only to be awakened by your neighbor's dog barking uncontrollably? For me it was last week. I tried to put a pillow over my head, but it was during the hot spell and the windows were open so that we could breath. This did not work; I started to sweat, so off came the pillow. I lay in bed thinking bad thoughts about why would someone be so rude that they would let a dog bark and wake up the neighborhood? I have to get up at 5:45am and sleep is a precious thing to me. Soon, I was angry and the more the dog barked, the madder I became. Then came a knock at the bedroom door: it was my youngest daughter saying that the dog barking woke her up and she has to get up early for school. By this time, I was livid. I pulled my pants on and grabbed my cell phone and was heading to the house behind me for a confrontation with the rude neighbors. Making a long story short: the dog stopped barking and I was able to get back to sleep and the dog has not barked since.

As I was jogging on the turf beside the bike path, I felt that mushy feeling of stepping on a big, steaming pile of dog excrement. The putrid smell filling my nostrils could only mean one thing: someone had taken their dog for a walk and let them use the wonderful green turf as their own doggie bathroom. This is one the most irresponsible thing that a dog owner can do. Take a walk down the bike path and look at the waste that these so-called responsible dog owners leave. If you take your dog for a walk, slip a plastic garbage bag in your pocket and pick up after your dog. If you see this behavior, let the dog owner know that they are breaking the law and that if they don't pick it up authorities will be notified.

I usually walk my dog several time each week. Actually, he walks me. But about once each week, a dog off leash will try to start a fight with my dog and me. I carry a cell phone and will not hesitate to call Public Safety about a dog off leash. Leaving your dog off leash is not

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what you should do in a urban environment with people and children all over the place; dogs have to be under control at all times. Last week a pit bull had pinned a young girl walking her dog against a fence. This must have been a terrifying experience: do you try to protect yourself, or protect your beloved dog? I was on the phone to Animal Control faster than you could say "greyhound". They were out here within 15 minutes to cite the owner. When they got on the scene, I gave the information and they told me that this is the second time this week they have been to this same address for the same dog harassing people and their animals. Some people just don't get it. If your dog causes damage to my dog or me, expect to be served with a lawsuit for damages.

None of these stores are true, but they could be. I made them up in order to make a point. How many of you have experienced any one of these problems? Dogs are a serious problem in Lakewood. Be a responsible dog owner and don't infringe on your neighbors right to peace and quiet, health and safety of person and property. ■



Letters to the LVNA

- Editor

Names have been withheld unless I have been given explicit permission to print them.

Dear Editor, 9/9/2002

It is GREAT!!! that you are putting this picnic together. But I have a slight suggestion: since I am a Hindu and therefore a vegetarian (no meat, white or red or even fish), I can not attend this picnic due to the lack in food for me and my family. How about some vegetarian food like tofu burgers? I would love it if this suggestion would be true next picnic.

- S.P., Lakemuir Drive

[Editor's note: my wife and I have been vegetarians for over 20 years, and this is a great suggestion. If anyone else is interested in having vegetarian food served at the picnic, contact me at editor@lvna.net and perhaps we can organize it for next year.]
□

Dear Editor, 9/9/2002

I have lived in the Lakewood area for over 20 years. I have watched the changes, both good and bad. I watched when people decided that they wanted to resurrect this neighborhood group, I watched it get itself in trouble, in national attention, local attention in the Mercury News. But over all, it has never ceased to amaze me that no matter what the changes, there is one constant that seems to be done by people in this newsletter and in the meetings: they complain. They complain about the city, they complain about the politicians, they complain about their neighbors. They complain, but never have I seen or heard these same people offer a plausible solution. That's not to say I haven't heard a wild comment offered as a solution, but never have I heard a plausible solution offered.

When some of the officers of this

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publication and group took it upon themselves to go around the neighborhood degrading peoples houses and landscaping, never did I hear this same group offer a solution such as getting a group of our neighbors together that may have the proper skills, to help those same people improve their homes at little or no cost. This would improve the neighborhood. I see almost the same initiative today dressed up as some lame beautification/blight management issue being presented for Lakehaven Drive and then forced on the rest of the people here. Not once is the issue taken that there may be people here through no fault of their own,forced out of work and not able to make improvements that maybe they and the neighborhood would like to see. Not once is it taken into account that there may be people that have homes here that are barely making it and would like to make improvements but can't. Some may go out and work on projects like "Habitat for Humanity" but never bring that spirit home to their own neighborhood. There was a complaint in the newsletter about the poor showing for the meetings to address this. I made an attempt to attend some of these meetings, but the couple of times that I attended and attempted to raise my voice in these meetings, I was ignored and voiced over.

I hear complaints about rats in the neighborhood. There have been rats around

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here since I have been here. Personally, I have always employed an extermination service, as a lot of people here do not take care of their homes and pets. Feeding pets outside encourages rats. Improper storage of garbage encourages rats. As long as man has been around, man has attracted rats. Wherever man is, there are rats. There were a bunch of wild cats at one time in the neighborhood, the rat population was at its lowest then. People complained about the cats and the humane society came out and trapped them. Back came the rats. I would rather have the cats. At least that way I don't have to put out toxic poisons to control the rats and every other animal that decides to try a bite.

Now it's a complaint about the roaches. Well, like I said, I have employed an exterminator for 20 years because people don't seem to care except to complain. Don't cover your garbage, leave pet food outside, along come the roaches. Leave food uncovered in your house, along come the roaches. For most of these complaints, there are simple common sense solutions, yet it is easier to complain and let someone else be responsible.

Take charge of your life, take responsibility for it. Stop complaining and start suggesting or helping to fix it. If your neighbors garbage is overflowing, put some of in your closed can. Take responsibility for cleaning up your own space first, and then HELP someone else clean up his or hers. It really is true, that we are a village, and in many years past, a village worked together to solve their problems, instead of asking the village next door to come clean up ours. That's what we are doing when we ask or tell the city to do it for us. It's not the city's fault, its not the city's problem, it's ours, we live here.

And above all, I have been sorely disappointed in the actions of this so-

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called association and its activities. Rather than find solutions and motivating this "village" of people to improve our lives together, they have blamed the residents and asked the "village next door" to solve the problems. They would rather report on the crimes here than help avoid them.

Start a neighborhood patrol, start more programs for the youth of our neighborhood. Get programs to use the park and its buildings more effectively. Where I grew up, the local park buildings were in constant use with programs for the youth of the neighborhood, with craft programs and teaching programs and educational assistance programs and sports programs like teaching tennis and evening basketball groups and evening story groups. I don't even have kids and I would be willing to help support programs like this. Kids and adults that have interests and a future don't get into trouble.

- Robey Angel

[Editor's note: Taking individual responsibility is a wonderful first step, but much of the letter is just another "complaint" unless the author and others who share his view are willing to go beyond individual responsibility and get involved at the neighborhood level. Go to the meetings, make yourself heard, organize the activities, work with the City, educate your neighbors, and work on those seemingly intractable problems. And if you are disappointed with the LVNA, then get elected and change it to your liking! In the author's own words, "start helping to fix it" – or – "stop complaining". ■

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Announcements

Register to Vote!

- Elena Anderson

If you are not registered to vote or have recently moved, you need to register no later than October 21st in order to vote on November 5th. Call Elena Anderson at 745-6028 if you would like to get a voter registration form. ■

Newsletter Walkers Needed

- Elena Anderson

Your LVNA is in need of a few good folks to help get the message out. It takes only a few minutes a month, gets you out of the house into the fresh air, and gives you an opportunity to meet some of your neighbors. If you can devote some time as a Newsletter Walker, please call Elena at 745-6028. It's a great way to make a contribution to the Neighborhood! ■

Advertise in *The Villager*

- Editor

Circulation of 1,700 households in Sunnyvale, delivered each month for free. For information and rates, call Mel at 745-6028. ■

LVNA General Meeting

- Editor

This month, the League of Women Voters will discuss the elections, and Scott Morton will discuss renovation plans for Lakewood Park.

All residents of Lakewood Village are encouraged to attend this monthly meeting. You will meet some of your neighbors, learn about upcoming events of special interest to our community, have a chance to voice your concerns and opinions, and help work towards a better neighborhood. Children are welcome.

The next meeting is:

Date: Wednesday, October 9th
Time: 7:00 p.m.
Place: Fairwood School ■

LVNA Board Meetings

- Craig Crawford

Any Lakewood Village resident, not just LVNA Board members, can attend the LVNA Board Meetings. If you are interested in attending an LVNA Board Meeting, contact Craig Crawford at 736-7371 or president@lvna.net. ■

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Hawaiian Special — Cheese, Canadian Bacon and Pineapple	$7.10	$10.40	$13.50
Rio Grande (All Meat) — Cheese, Salami, Pepperoni, Ham, Canadian Bacon, Pastrami, Beef, Linguica and Italian Sausage	$9.50	$14.70	$17.65
Southern Express (Pesto) — Cheese, Pesto Sauce, Chicken, Zucchini, Mushrooms, Olives, Tomatoes, and Green Onions	$8.55	$12.95	$15.95
Pacific Rim — Cheese, Thai sauce, Chicken, Onions, Carrots, Green Onions, and Cilantro	$8.55	$12.95	$15.95

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Additional Items: 75¢ S – 90¢ M – $1.15 L

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One coupon per group. Not valid with other offers. Add $1.50 delivery. Exp. 6-07-2001
LVNA

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$3.00 Off any large pizza or
$7.00 Off any 2 large pizzas
(408) 245-7760
One coupon per group. Add $1.50 delivery. Not valid with other offers. Exp. 6-07-2001
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Calendar of Upcoming Events

What	Where	When
Compost Workshop	Sunnyvale Community Center	10/12/02 10am-noon
Household Hazardous Waste Drop-off	164 Carl Rd. Transfer Station	10/19/02 8am-1pm
Bookmobile	Fairwood School	10/15, 10/29 3:20-3:45pm
Bookmobile	Lakewood School	10/17, 10/31 1:30-3pm
Fall Cleanup	Your house and yard!	9/30/02 – 10/25/02
Election Day	Your designated polling place	11/5/02

Important Phone Numbers

Public Safety – Emergency		**911**
Public Safety – Non-emergency		**730-7100**
Parks and Maintenance		730-7506
Animal Control		730-7178
Code Enforcement		730-7610
Crime Prevention		730-7140
Hazardous Materials		730-7212
Housing Inspection		730-7610
Lakewood Pool		734-8190
Street Light Repairs		730-7510
Shopping Cart Retrieval		730-7510
NRO	Dave Falletta	730-7148
Vehicle Abatement	Michelle Raff	730-7104
Neighborhood Preservation	Rich Gutierrez	730-7447

Internet Links

Lakewood Village / LVNA Web Site	http://www.lvna.net
Lakewood Village email list	http://www.topica.com/lists/lakewoodvillage

For other Internet Links, go to http://www.lvna.net/Resources/Links/links.html

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